The Union Cabinet also decided to include the Chairperson of the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) as a permanent invitee (non-voting) to all proceedings of the Council.

WORKING

The decisions of the Council are taken at its meetings. One-half of the total number of members of the Council is the quorum for conducting a meeting. Every decision of the Council is to be taken by a majority of not less than three-fourths of the weighted votes of the members present and voting at the meeting. The decision is taken in accordance with the following principles:

1. **The vote of the central government shall have a weightage of one-third of the total votes cast in that meeting.**
2. **The votes of all the state governments combined shall have a weightage of two-thirds of the total votes cast in that meeting.**

Any act or proceedings of the Council will not become invalid on the following grounds:

1. **any vacancy or defect in the constitution of the Council; or**
2. **any defect in the appointment of a person as a member of the Council; or**
3. **any procedural irregularity of the Council not affecting the merits of the case.**

FUNCTIONS

The Council is required to make recommendations to the centre and the states on the following matters:

1. **The taxes, cesses and surcharges levied by the centre, the states and the local bodies that would get merged in GST.**
2. **The goods and services that may be subjected to GST or exempted from GST.**
3. **Model GST Laws, principles of levy, apportionment of GST levied on supplies in the course of inter-state trade or commerce and the principles that govern the place of supply.**
4. **The threshold limit of turnover below which goods and services may be exempted from GST.**
5. **The rates including floor rates with bands of GST.**
6. **Any special rate or rates for a specified period to raise additional resources during any natural calamity or disaster.**
7. **Special provision with respect to the states of Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Jammu and Kashmir[3], Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim, Tripura, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand.**